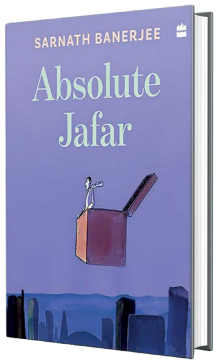
BOOKS TO LOOK FORWARD TO IN 2026

AFTER NATIONS The Making and Unmaking of a World Order
By Rana Dasgupta
Penguin/ Allen Lane
Non-fiction

Rana Dasgupta's last book, *Capital* (2014), was an astute mapping of New Delhi's socio-economic trajectories in the 21st century. His new work of nonfiction is even more ambitious, unpacking the historic origins of the nation-state itself. As democracies around the world approach a tipping point, and autocracies like Russia and China grow more ascendant every year, Dasgupta sketches the likely political endgame of the nation-state system.

ONCE ELEPHANTS LIVED HERE
By Geetanjali Shree
Translated by Daisy Rockwell
Penguin/ Hamish Hamilton
Fiction

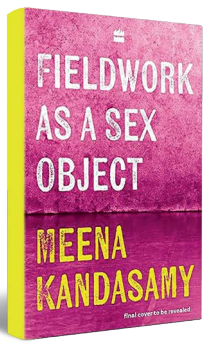
The International Booker-winning combination of Hindi writer Geetanjali Shree and translator Daisy Rockwell returns with *Once Elephants Lived Here*, a collection of short fiction. The titular story is an elegiac portrayal of communal violence, while other entries in the collection are sophisticated depictions of the conflicts that modernity inevitably sparks in a rapidly changing society.



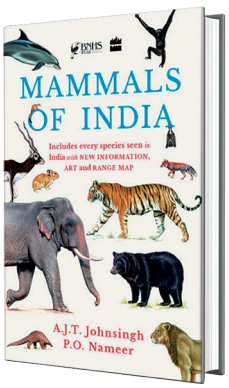
ABSOLUTE JAFAR
By Sarnath Banerjee
HarperCollins India
Fiction

Sarnath Banerjee's *Corridor* (2004) and *The Barn-Owl's Wondrous Capers* (2007) are among the pioneering English-language graphic novels to come out of India. His new book *Absolute Jafar* is perhaps his most personal work yet. Bhrigu, the hunter of obscure collectibles who Banerjee described as a 'post-modern Ibn Batuta' in *Corridor*, returns here with a tale about his son Jafar—a tale of displacement, exile and identity.

FIELDWORK AS A SEX OBJECT
By Meena Kandasamy
HarperCollins India
Fiction

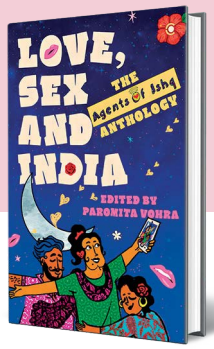


Meena Kandasamy, author of *The Gypsy Goddess* and *When I Hit You*, is known for her politically charged and formally inventive novels. In *Fieldwork as a Sex Object*, Kandasamy tells us the story of a young Indian woman living in London, who becomes the target of a vicious online harassment campaign triggered by a sex scandal.



MAMMALS OF INDIA
By A.J.T. Johnsingh and P.O. Nameer
HarperCollins India
Nonfiction

Two renowned professors of wildlife science have compiled the first comprehensive field guide to the 450-plus species of Indian mammals currently recognised. A must-have for wildlife enthusiasts, *Mammals of India* has been published in collaboration with BNHS (Bombay Natural History Society) and contains over 400 distribution maps and 50-plus full-colour illustrations.

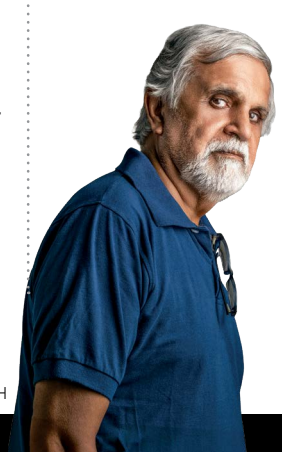


LOVE SEX INDIA
By Paromita Vohra
Westland/ Context
Non-fiction

Documentary filmmaker and columnist Paromita Vohra co-founded the Agents of Ishq website in 2014, designed to be a platform about love, sexuality and desire. In the anthology *Love Sex India*, Vohra compiles real-life accounts of Indians from all walks of life, as they discuss their desires, their expectations and, occasionally, their kinks.

THE APPARITION
By M.G. Vassanji
Westland/ Tranquebar
Fiction

Born in Kenya to Indian immigrant parents, M.G. Vassanji is known for novels like *The In-Between world of Vikram Lall* (2003) and *The Assassin's Song* (2007), elegant dissections of diasporic and religious identity, respectively. In his latest novel, he follows the Mughal emperor Alauddin Khilji as he



BANDEEP SINGH



MARIA BOYADGIS

contemplates handing over power to his wily vizier Malik Kafur, a decision that could shake the very foundations of his empire.

HOMETOWN
A Personal History of Shillong
By Anjum Hasan
Bloomsbury India
Non-fiction

Through complex, thoughtfully constructed novels like *The Cosmopolitans* (2015) and *History's Angels* (2022), Anjum Hasan has established herself as one of the most versatile English-language writers in the country. Her latest work is a personal history of Shillong, the town she grew up in and the setting of her celebrated debut novel *Lunatic in My Head* (2007).

THE BENGAL READER: The Finest Fiction, Nonfiction, Poetry and Plays from the Bengali